Use of Funds

brio

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$2.0M Pre-Seed | 26-Month Runway | March 2026

Overview

This document shows how Brio allocates a $2M pre-seed round to reach commercial repeatability & Series A readiness. The plan funds 26 months of build and go-to-market – delivering a production-ready platform, validated revenue model, and defensible supplier network.

Round Snapshot

Round Type	Pre-Seed (SAFE or priced)
Raise	$2,000,000 USD
Runway	26 months
Objective	Achieve commercial repeatability and Series A readiness
Key Targets	$1M+ ARR run-rate, 15 active suppliers, ~$120M GMV processed

Primary Deliverables Funded:

- Completion of buyer surface <> supplier portal
- Development of AI ingestion, ERP/Accounting integrations, and payments modules
- Launch of LLM ordering with embedded finance
- GTM, onboarding 15 live suppliers
- Demonstrate GMV scale (~$120M) and revenue conversion (~$1M ARR)

View Sankey ↗

Allocation Summary

Each category below links to a detailed section. Numbers reflect loaded costs including a standard operating buffer per line.

Category	%	Amount	Purpose
Team ↗	65%	$1,317,000	Two co-founders, two contract engineers, sales and EA/GTM hires across 26 months. Includes California employer payroll taxes.
Operations & Infra ↗	5%	$91,000	Cloud hosting, AI API costs, SaaS and dev tooling across the full runway.
GTM & Partnerships ↗	6%	$100,000	Supplier activation, events, outreach, brand, demo assets, and onboarding systems.
Compliance & Legal ↗	4%	$80,000	Legal, accounting, insurance, and operating infrastructure for Series A readiness.
Reserve & Buffer ↗	20%	$412,000	Operational contingency, extended runway, additional GTM support, and unplanned integrations.
Total		$2,000,000	

Burn Profile

Average monthly burn rises as the team scales and supplier onboarding accelerates. The reserve buffer absorbs timing variance without requiring bridge financing.

Phase	Duration	Monthly Burn	Phase Total
Pilots	M1 – M4	~$56K/mo	~$224K
GTM	M5 – M9	~$82K/mo	~$384K
Growth	M10 – M18	~$82K/mo	~$737K
Repeatability	M19 – M26	~$82K/mo	~$655K

Peak burn occurs during M10-M18 when the full team is operational and supplier onboarding is at full speed. The reserve and buffer absorbs unexpected costs, integration complexity, or any slippage between pre-seed close and Series A.

Milestone Alignment

Timeline	Milestone	Funded By	Success Indicator
M1 – M4	First live transaction; pilot success	Team + Operations & Infra	Real buyer places order through COR; 1–3 suppliers, 25+ orders
M5 – M6	Core ingestion, ERP, payments live.	Team + Operations & Infra	Platform foundation complete; first supplier transactions running
M6 – M9	5 sups live; repeatable onboarding. Sales + GTM	Team + GTM	Onboarding < 1 month; ~$20M GMV processed
M10 – M18	Embedded finance (partner) launched	Team + Operations & Infra	>25% transactions processed on credit
M18 – M26	15 suppliers, ~$1M ARR	Full team	Series A readiness; ~$120M GMV run-rate
Ongoing	Compliance, reporting, runway stability	Compliance & Legal	Clean books, insurance, audit-ready data room

Team

Team

$1,317,000 | 65% of Raise

Funds the full team driving Brio's technical build, integrations, and supplier operations over a 26-month runway. Engineering is managed by founding CTO & two proven contract engineers, eliminating the need for costly FTE hires while maintaining output equivalent to a 6-8 person team w/ fully AI-augmented dev model.

Team Structure

Role	Type	Start	Focus
Charlie (CEO)	Co-founder/FTE SF	M1	Operations, sales, fundraising, partnerships, GTM strategy.
Beknazar (CTO)	Co-founder/FTE SF	M1	Architecture, COR agent, AI systems, product. Manages AI-augmented engineering team.
Abat (Hungary)	Contract	On funding	ERP integrations, data pipelines. Existing relationship, no ramp-up.
Baymurat (KL)	Contract	On funding	Conversational AI, agent UX. Existing relationship, no ramp-up.
Sales Hire	FTE/US	M6-10	Supplier acquisition, pipeline development, closing.
GTM	FTE/SF	M6-10	Marketing, onboarding management, project management, coordination.

Compensation Model

Base salaries are shown separately from California employer payroll taxes (~9% on FTE roles). International contractors carry no CA payroll burden.

Role	Annual	Duration	Base Total	Tax Burden (~9%)
Bek (CTO)	$140,000	26 mo	$303,000	~$27,000
Charlie (CEO)	$140,000	26 mo	$303,000	~$27,000
Abat (Hungary)	$2,500/mo	26 mo	$65,000	—
Baymurat (KL)	$2,500/mo	26 mo	$65,000	—

Role	Annual	Duration	Base Total	Tax Burden (~9%)
Sales Hire	$140,000	20 mo (M6)	$233,000	~$21,000
GTM	$150,000	20 mo (M6)	$250,000	~$23,000
Total			**$1,219,000**	**~$98,000**

Engineering Notes

- Both contract engineers are trusted, existing relationships from past ventures, reducing risk, ramp up, and cost.
- We've built Brio's engineering team on a fully AI-native development stack: AI agents for coding, testing, deployment, and documentation. This delivers faster cycles and lower operational debt as the product scales. Our 3 person engineering team produces at the output level of a 6-8 person traditional team.

Operations & Infra

Operations & Infrastructure

$91,000 | 5% of Raise

Covers all cloud hosting, AI API usage, and core SaaS tooling required to run Brio across the full 26-month runway. These are operational costs that scale with supplier count and transaction volume.

Monthly Cost Range

Cloud Hosting	Supabase, Vercel, MongoDB Atlas → $800–1,500/mo. Low at pilot stage; scales with supplier count.
AI API Costs	Claude / Anthropic — $1,000–3,000/mo. Per-query pricing (~$0.02–0.10 per COR interaction). Increases w/ volume.
Domain, Email & SaaS	Dev tools, Slack, GitHub, PM tools, misc → $300–500/mo.
Monthly Subtotal	~$2,100–5,000/mo. Budgeted at $3,500/mo average over 26 months.
26-Month Total	**~$91,000**

GTM & Partnerships

GTM & Partnerships

$100,000 | 6% of Raise

Funds supplier-facing work to validate adoption, build trust, and prove repeatability. Our approach is account-based, targeting 15 anchor suppliers through direct outreach and targeted events. Because supplier relationships already exist, this phase focuses on activation vs discovery. The $100k is used to accelerate beyond our committed pipeline and expand into adjacent verticals.

Line Items

Item	Budget	Purpose
Industry Travel & Events	$5,000	Sea Otter, CABDA, Outdoor Retailer. Multiple qualified meetings per cycle.
Account-Based Outreach	$15,000	Data tools, outreach software, and demo materials for founder-led campaigns.
Onboarding Experience	$10,000	Standardized onboarding system. Suppliers live in under two weeks with minimal human-in-loop.
Website & Brand	$10,000	Product site and design system for supplier credibility and investor readiness.
Demo Support	$5,000	Pilot environment, sandboxing, LLM call costs, and integration stipend for anchor suppliers.
Video Production	$15,000	3x high-quality case study and demo walkthrough videos. Reusable for investor and supplier outreach.
Additional GTM Reserve	$40,000	Additional supplier events, booth, outreach, or expansion vertical support as pipeline scales.
Total	**$100,000**	

Targets

Suppliers Onboarded	15 across cycling, outdoor, and first expansion vertical by M26
GMV Run-Rate	~$120M annualized across onboarded suppliers
ARR Generated	$1M+ prior to Series A
CAC per Supplier	<$5,000 all-in

Onboarding Speed	< 1 month from greenlight to live catalog
Lighthouse Accounts	3-5 anchor suppliers as reference proof points

Compliance & Legal

Compliance & Legal

$80,000 | 4% of Raise

Funds the legal, financial, and infrastructure required to maintain clean books, documentation, and remain properly protected throughout the runway.

Line Items

Legal & Compliance	$25,000 Corporate counsel, contract templates, filings, and compliance.
Accounting & Tax	$25,000 Bookkeeping, tax prep, and financial reporting across the 26-month runway.
Insurance	$20,000 General liability, cyber, and D&O coverage for enterprise and investor assurance.
Operating Infrastructure	$10,000 Cap table (Carta), data room, workspace, and documentation systems.
Total	$80,000

Milestone Targets

M0 – M6	Legal counsel, Carta, and bookkeeping in place. Corporate compliance established.
M6 – M12	Monthly financials, reporting templates, and insurance coverages.
Ongoing	Quarterly investor reports covering spend vs. milestones, GMV, ARR, and runway variance.
M22 – M24	Audit-ready financials, and diligence materials packaged for institutional investors.

Reserve & Buffer

Reserve & Buffer

$412,000 | 20% of Raise

The reserve provides financial stability across the full 26-month plan. It is sized to reflect the current fundraising environment – the seed-to-Series A timeline now averages > 2 years. ERP integration costs are difficult to predict precisely; this buffer covers the difference. It also funds opportunistic GTM spend as it arises, such as new verticals, specific industry events, or targeted account-based campaigns that weren't planned at close.

Reserve Allocation

Operational Contingency & Extended Runway	Covers timing delays, cost overruns, and the gap between pre-seed close and Series A without requiring a bridge round.
Additional GTM Support	Incremental supplier activation, expanded outreach, or acceleration into a second vertical as pipeline velocity dictates.
Unplanned Integration Development	Additional ERP, IMS, or accounting connectors that emerge from supplier requirements (e.g., connectors beyond NetSuite, Fishbowl, and QuickBooks).

Why ~20%?

Brio's reserve is sized at 20% to reflect three specific risks:

- First-time back of house systems and integration costs are difficult to predict precisely. Each connector must be engineered for the first customer instance.
- The seed-to-Series A timeline now averages over two years
- Opportunistic GTM spend: new verticals, events, and account-based campaigns that emerge as the pipeline scales